

# Blood Moon Over America: Sign Of The Times - Or Just Another Eclipse?

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Wars are raging, nations are threatening nations, extreme weather and devastating floods are striking communities around the world, and earthquakes continue to shake populated regions. Political instability is spreading, geopolitical tensions are rising, and millions increasingly sense that the world has entered a period of unusual turbulence.

And now, on Thursday night, millions of Americans will look up and watch the moon turn red.

Beginning on the evening of August 27 and continuing into the early hours of August 28, Earth's shadow will move across the moon in one of the deepest partial lunar eclipses most Americans will ever see. At precisely 12:12 a.m. Eastern Time, the eclipse will reach its maximum, with approximately 96 percent of the lunar surface covered and only a thin sliver remaining illuminated.

As the eclipse deepens, much of the moon could take on shades of copper, orange and blood red. Nearly one billion people across the United States, Canada and Latin America are positioned to see the entire eclipse, weather permitting, making this far more than an obscure astronomical event visible only from some distant corner of the world.

Under ordinary circumstances, it would simply be a spectacular night in the heavens. But these aren't ordinary times, and whenever the moon turns blood red against the backdrop of war, natural disasters and geopolitical upheaval, Christians understandably begin thinking about Bible prophecy.

## We've Heard This Language Before

Thousands of years before anyone used the modern phrase "blood moon," the prophet Joel wrote, "The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before the great and the terrible day of the Lord come" (Joel 2:31). The Apostle Peter repeated those words in Acts 2, connecting the imagery of the heavens with the prophetic Day of the Lord.

Then there is the unmistakable language of Revelation 6:12: "And I beheld when he had opened the sixth seal, and, lo, there was a great earthquake; and the sun became black as sackcloth of hair, and the moon became as blood."

Jesus Himself warned that the period surrounding His return would be accompanied by extraordinary celestial events, declaring in Luke 21:25 that there would be "signs in the sun, and in the moon, and in the stars."

So when millions of Americans walk outside Thursday night and see a reddish moon hanging over the nation, the question is inevitable: Are we witnessing a sign of the times--or just another eclipse?

The answer requires biblical discernment rather than either sensationalism or dismissal.

## This Blood Moon Isn't Revelation 6

There is nothing scientifically mysterious about why Thursday's moon will appear red. During a lunar eclipse, Earth passes between the sun and moon, while Earth's atmosphere filters the sunlight passing through it. Shorter blue wavelengths scatter more easily, while more red and orange light continues through the atmosphere and reaches the lunar surface--the same basic phenomenon responsible for brilliant red sunsets.

Astronomers can predict eclipses far into the future, which means this eclipse didn't suddenly appear in response to today's wars, earthquakes or political crises. Christians have repeatedly made the mistake of assigning specific prophetic significance to eclipses, comets, planetary alignments and other astronomical events, only to watch predicted dates come and go without the expected prophetic fulfillment.

Biblical watchfulness should never become prophetic sensationalism. Yet there is an opposite mistake that deserves just as much caution: becoming so determined not to sensationalize prophecy that we begin ignoring

what prophecy actually says.

The Bible really does say that extraordinary signs are coming in the heavens.

### **Look At The World Around Us**

Consider the setting in which this blood moon is appearing. The Russia-Ukraine war continues to produce massive drone and missile attacks, conflicts across the Middle East have repeatedly threatened wider escalation, and other parts of the world remain trapped in devastating wars and humanitarian crises.

At the same time, destructive floods, droughts, wildfires and extreme weather continue to affect populations across the globe. Earthquakes regularly remind us how quickly the ground beneath entire cities can become unstable, while political and economic uncertainty is adding another layer of anxiety for populations already wondering what comes next.

None of these individual developments proves that we have reached the final fulfillment of biblical prophecy. Wars, earthquakes, floods and eclipses have all occurred throughout human history, and Christians should resist the temptation to point to every headline and declare that a specific prophecy has been fulfilled.

But Jesus did tell His followers to pay attention to the larger pattern.

In Matthew 24, Christ spoke of wars and rumors of wars, nation rising against nation, famines, pestilences and earthquakes. He compared these developments to birth pains, an especially significant analogy because birth pains are not defined merely by their existence but by the way they eventually become increasingly difficult to ignore as the moment of delivery approaches.

That is why the most important question may not be, "Is Thursday's blood moon prophetic?" The better question is whether we are paying attention to the larger picture developing around us.

### **The Blood Moon Isn't The Prophecy--But It Reminds Us Of One**

Revelation 6 describes something vastly more dramatic than Thursday night's eclipse. There is a great earthquake, the sun becomes black, the moon becomes like blood, stars fall from heaven, and the heavens themselves appear to recede.

Whatever the precise physical mechanisms behind those future events, Scripture portrays something unmistakable and terrifying. Humanity will not need to debate on social media about whether something unusual has occurred; the scale of the events described will make that obvious.

Thursday night's eclipse isn't that event, but imagine standing outside shortly after midnight and watching almost the entire moon become darkened and reddish. For a brief moment, millions of people will see something that visually resembles imagery God placed in His Word thousands of years ago.

That should make us think--not speculate wildly, set dates or declare that the sixth seal has been opened, but seriously consider what Scripture says is ultimately coming.

Because one day the passages Christians have studied for generations will cease to be merely prophetic descriptions of the future. One day the signs Jesus described will actually occur, and the world will experience events that cannot simply be dismissed as business as usual.

### **Keep Looking Up**

There is something strangely appropriate about millions of people stepping outside Thursday night and raising their eyes toward the heavens. Our attention is normally directed everywhere else--to our phones, politics, money, entertainment, work and the endless stream of crises filling our screens--but for one night, millions will simply look up.

Those words should mean something special to Christians.

After describing the extraordinary events that would eventually unfold upon the earth, Jesus told His followers in Luke 21:28, "And when these things begin to come to pass, then look up, and lift up your heads; for your redemption draweth nigh."

Thursday night's blood moon may simply be an eclipse, and we don't need to turn every unusual event in the heavens into a prophetic declaration. But neither should ordinary explanations for individual events blind us to the extraordinary picture Scripture tells us will eventually emerge when the appointed time arrives.

So Thursday night, take a moment to look up. Admire God's creation, remember what Scripture says is ultimately coming, and remain watchful in a world where the headlines increasingly remind us how quickly circumstances can change.

The blood moon over America may not itself be the sign. But against the backdrop of the times in which we are living, it provides a powerful reminder of why Jesus told His followers to watch for the signs of the times.

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